

THE PACKARD LAW FIRM

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Things to Remember From Your Appointment

We are so glad you have chosen The Packard Law Firm to represent you on your claim for disability benefits. We understand that getting started with disability can be overwhelming, here are a few things to keep you and your claim organized.

Q: *How long does a decision take?*

A: Some win a few months after they apply. Most people get denied twice before being approved. The whole process can take **over two years**. The first phase (Initial Claim) usually takes around 6 or 7 months before a decision is made. The second phase (Request for Reconsideration) usually lasts between 4 and 5 months before a decision is made. The third phase (Request for a hearing) usually lasts around 16 or 18 months before a decision is made. (See time line attached)

Q: *What can I do to improve my chances of winning my case?*

A: The most important thing for you to do is **get as much medical treatment as you can afford!** Talk with your doctors about ALL of your limitations. Be specific in describing your disabilities to your doctor, and don't let your doctor rush through your appointment.

Important Reminders

Please contact your case manager if one of the following occurs:

- You get a letter from the Social Security office
- You receive new medical treatment, or go to a new medical treatment facility
- You are hospitalized (stay overnight), or have important tests done (MRI, CT, etc.)
- You go back to work
- You change your address and/or telephone number

Do not submit medical records to your Case Manager, we will order them for you

Return the Function Report and Work History Report within 2 weeks (Initial Applications *only*)

If you need to renew your Carelink, please call us 24 hours before your Carelink appointment to get a Proof of Representation letter from our office

If the Social Security office calls you, it's okay to answer their questions as long as you feel comfortable; if not, ask them to call our office

Sign and return the Internet Application Summary form back to the SSA's local office

If you have any questions, please refer to your case manager's contact sheet which provides their phone and email contact information.

New Medical Treatment Worksheet

Use this simple worksheet to keep track of any NEW medical treatment you receive after you first meet with us. This will make it easy for you to give us treatment updates in the future.

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All of us at the Packard Law Firm would like to extend our gratitude for having the opportunity to work with you. The Packard Law Firm is consistently working to ensure that we are not only providing, but also improving our service to our clients, and for this we ask for your assistance. We would sincerely appreciate you taking a few more minutes of your time to like or follow our pages on social media so others may find legal assistance as well.

With the instructions below, we ask you that spare a couple of minutes to like or follow our pages on social media, and in doing so, assist others in their future legal matters.



1. Facebook - www.facebook.com/ThePackardLawFirm/



2. Twitter - <https://twitter.com/packardlaw>



3. LinkedIn - www.linkedin.com/company/the-packard-law-firm



4. Google+ - <https://plus.google.com/u/0/+Packardfirm/posts>



5. Yelp - www.yelp.com/biz/packard-law-firm-san-antonio

While we have enjoyed working with you, it is sincerest hope that you do not find yourself in need of our legal services again. If you do however, please know that we practice in the following areas: Social Security Disability, Personal Injury, and Special Needs Planning.

Warm regards,



Samuel Packard
The Packard Law Firm

Poisonous Drugs that have become major lawsuits

Many pharmaceutical companies have manufactured drugs and products where they put profits ahead of people. The following drugs and medical products have been recalled and are the source of major lawsuits.

Name	Details	Injuries to look for
Hernia Mesh	Polypropylene or plastic mesh (not from a corpse, ligament or porcine) Implanted from 2005-present	Severe infection, skin rash near incision, hernia recurrence, bowel obstruction, adhesions
IVC Filters	From Cook, Bard and Cordis.	IVC filter is still implanted and/or client has had a fracture, migration, perforation or erosion to vena cava wall or other organs
Blood Thinners: Xarelto, Pradaxa and Eliquis	On blood thinner for at least 2 weeks	Gastrointestinal bleeding event, hemorrhagic stroke resulting in hospitalization, blood transfusion or death
TVM Mesh	Implanted after 2006	Revision surgery. This means surgical procedure under general anesthesia removing at least a portion of the mesh
Talc Powder – Commonly known as Johnson and Johnson Baby Powder	4 years continuous use/8 years every other day use	Diagnosed with ovarian cancer over age of 18 and under age of 62

If you have experienced complications with any of the above mentioned drugs, call Dan Packard at 210-340-8877 today!